



● ELITE PLAN · \$34.99 CAD/MONTH

4 COMPLETE WEEKS

MEDITERRANEAN DIET

The most studied eating pattern in the world, rebuilt around **athlete** macros and 28 days planned meal by meal.

28 DAYS

20 RECIPES

SHOPPING LIST

BATCH COOKING



MEDITERRANEAN
The plate, divided

112

MEALS PLANNED

20

PREMIUM RECIPES

17

ITEMS TO BUY

10

PAGES

THE MEDITERRANEAN DIET FOR ATHLETES

It is not just cardiovascular health. It is the pattern that best combines antioxidants, healthy fats, quality carbohydrates and micronutrient density — exactly what a body under hard training needs.

WEEK	KCAL	PROTEIN	CARBS	FATS	GOAL OF THE WEEK
1 • Adaptation	2.400	150 g	280 g	80 g	Remove ultra-processed food without suffering
2 • Consolidation	2.500	160 g	295 g	82 g	Master the pattern and the shopping
3 • Variety	2.500	165 g	300 g	83 g	Widen the recipe book
4 • Maintenance	2.600	170 g	310 g	85 g	Turn it into a way of living

Values calculated for a 75 kg athlete training 4–5 sessions a week. Scale them proportionally to your own body weight.

THE 6 PILLARS OF THE MEDITERRANEAN PATTERN

DAILY BASE

- Extra-virgin olive oil as the main fat
- Vegetables at lunch and at dinner, without exception
- Wholegrain cereals and pulses as the base carbohydrate

WEEKLY FREQUENCY

- Fish 3–4 times, of which 2 oily fish
- Pulses 3–4 times, eggs 4–6 units
- Red meat 1–2 times at most

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Breakfast, snack, lunch and dinner for all 28 days

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SUNDAY BATCH COOKING

Two hours that settle your whole week

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WEEK 1 · ADAPTATION

2,400 kcal · 150 g protein · 280 g carbohydrate · 80 g fat. This week the goal is not perfection, it is **getting ultra-processed food** out of the house.

DAY	BREAKFAST	SNACK	LUNCH	DINNER
Mon	Greek yoghurt + walnuts + honey + blueberries	Almonds + apple	Salmon 180 g + brown rice + Greek salad	Chickpeas with spinach and garlic
Tue	Wholegrain toast + EVOO + tomato + oregano	Hummus + carrot	Lentils with vegetables and red pepper	Courgette omelette + salad
Wed	Oats + plant milk + banana + cinnamon	Walnuts + pear	Grilled chicken 200 g + quinoa + broccoli	Minestrone + wholegrain bread
Thu	Scrambled eggs + cherry tomatoes + basil	Yoghurt + kiwi	Wholegrain pasta + pesto + sun-dried tomatoes + cheese	Baked sea bream + potato + lemon
Fri	Smoothie: spinach + mango + protein + milk	Dates + almonds	Niçoise salad (tuna, egg, olives, green beans)	Steamed hake + roasted vegetables
Sat	Oat pancakes + maple syrup + berries	Seasonal fruit	Vegetable paella + light aioli	Rosemary lamb + couscous + mint
Sun	Homemade granola + almond milk + strawberries	Walnuts + orange	Mediterranean stew (chickpea, chicken, vegetables)	Large salad + feta + EVOO

KEYS TO THIS WEEK

- Clear the cupboard of pastries, soft drinks and salty snacks **before** Monday.
- Buy the extra-virgin olive oil in a large format: it will be your main fat.
- If you go off plan one day, the next meal goes back on plan. No compensating.
- Drink 2.5–3 litres of water: as the fibre goes up, your body needs it.

FEELING FULLER IN THE FIRST WEEK IS NORMAL

You are going to eat a considerably greater volume of food for the same energy. If you struggle to finish your plates, spread the vegetables across more meals and add an extra spoonful of oil so you do not fall short on calories.

WEEK 2 · CONSOLIDATION

2,500 kcal · 160 g protein · 295 g carbohydrate · 82 g fat. The goal is for **shopping and cooking** to stop costing you mental effort.

DAY	BREAKFAST	SNACK	LUNCH	DINNER
Mon	Wholegrain toast + avocado + poached egg	Greek yoghurt + walnuts	Brown rice + lemon chicken + pisto	Pumpkin soup + plain omelette
Tue	Oat porridge + figs + almond	Apple + fresh cheese	Cod + potato + green beans	Chickpea, tuna and pepper salad
Wed	Greek yoghurt + granola + raspberries	Toast + tomato + ham	Wholegrain spaghetti + lean beef bolognese	Fish soup + wholegrain bread
Thu	Mushroom scramble with 3 eggs + toast	A handful of pistachios	Wholegrain couscous + spiced chicken + vegetables	Caprese salad + light potato omelette
Fri	Banana, oat and protein smoothie	Carrot + hummus	Baked salmon + sweet potato + asparagus	Aubergine stuffed with quinoa and turkey
Sat	Baked wholegrain torrijas + berries	Orange + almonds	Seafood paella	Lentil salad + boiled egg
Sun	Spinach omelette + bread + EVOO	Grapes + walnuts	Roast chicken + rosemary potatoes + salad	Leek soup + feta + toast

KEYS TO THIS WEEK

- Do the shopping **once only**, with the list on page 9 in hand.
- On Sunday, cook the rice, the quinoa and the pulses for three days ahead.
- Bring in oily fish twice: salmon on Friday, seafood on Saturday.
- Note the two dishes you liked most: they will be your fallbacks when time is short.

THE DINNER TRICK

Every dinner this week takes under 20 minutes and will happily absorb whatever vegetables were left over from lunch. The Mediterranean dinner is light by design: the bulk of the carbohydrate goes at midday, around training.

WEEK 3 · VARIETY

2,500 kcal · 165 g protein · 300 g carbohydrate · 83 g fat. The recipe book widens so the pattern **never gets boring**.

DAY	BREAKFAST	SNACK	LUNCH	DINNER
Mon	Oats with pure cocoa and banana	Yoghurt + kiwi	Seared fresh tuna + rice + vegetable stir-fry	Tomato soup + toast with sardines
Tue	Rye toast + fresh cheese + honey	Almonds + pear	Mediterranean curried chicken + couscous	Courgette omelette + rocket salad
Wed	Yoghurt bowl + granola + blueberries	Hummus + crudités	Hake in salsa verde + potato + peas	Wholegrain pasta salad + tuna + olives
Thu	Scrambled eggs + spinach + toast	Banana + walnuts	Lean beef + roast sweet potato + broccoli	Gazpacho + chicken skewers
Fri	Green smoothie + protein + oats	Fresh cheese + tomato	Wholegrain mushroom risotto + chicken	Baked sea bream + roasted vegetables
Sat	Oat pancakes + berries	Seasonal fruit	Seafood fideuá	Greek salad + hard-boiled egg
Sun	Toast + avocado + smoked salmon	Orange + pistachios	Roast lamb + couscous + mint	Courgette soup + omelette

KEYS TO THIS WEEK

- Try at least **three new recipes** from the recipe book on pages 7 and 8.
- Swap the fish for whatever is in season and best priced at your fishmonger.
- Use fresh herbs: basil, mint, parsley and oregano completely change a dish.
- If you eat out one day, order grilled fish or meat with vegetables and a potato side.

EAT IN SEASON

Seasonal produce has more flavour, more nutrient density and costs less. Swap any vegetable or fruit in the plan for its seasonal equivalent without hesitation: the pattern is what matters, not the exact ingredient.

WEEK 4 · MAINTENANCE

2,600 kcal · 170 g protein · 310 g carbohydrate · 85 g fat. This week you are no longer “on a diet”: this is simply **how you eat**.

DAY	BREAKFAST	SNACK	LUNCH	DINNER
Mon	Oat porridge + apple and cinnamon	Greek yoghurt + honey	Lemon chicken + brown rice + salad	Minestrone + feta
Tue	Wholegrain toast + tomato + serrano ham	Walnuts + mandarin	Braised lentils with vegetables	Grilled salmon + asparagus
Wed	Protein + banana + oat smoothie	Hummus + wholegrain pitta	Wholegrain pasta + pesto + chicken	Mushroom scramble + salad
Thu	Greek yoghurt + granola + berries	Almonds + pear	Cod with chickpeas and spinach	Light potato omelette + salad
Fri	Wholegrain French toast + strawberries	Fresh cheese + walnuts	Beef + baked potato + peppers	Vegetable soup + prawn skewers
Sat	Poached eggs + spinach + toast	Fruit + pistachios	Valencian paella	Quinoa, avocado and tuna salad
Sun	Mediterranean bowl: yoghurt, figs and walnuts	Grapes + almonds	Light stew (chickpea, chicken, vegetables)	Baked fish + large salad

HOW TO CARRY ON FROM HERE

YOUR GOAL	ADJUSTMENT TO WEEK 4
Maintain weight	Repeat week 4 indefinitely, rotating through all four weeks
Build muscle	Add 300–400 kcal: more rice, pasta or wholegrain bread at lunch
Lose fat	Take off 350–450 kcal: cut the dinner carbohydrate and one spoonful of oil
Endurance performance	Raise the carbohydrate the day before long sessions

YOU HAVE COMPLETED 28 DAYS

Rotate these four weeks indefinitely. That is the great advantage of the Mediterranean pattern over any fad diet: **it has no expiry date**, because it does not depend on restricting whole food groups.

20 PREMIUM RECIPES · PART 1

#	RECIPE	TIME · KCAL	INGREDIENTS AND METHOD
1	Avocado tzatziki	5 min · 180 kcal Vegan	Ripe avocado, coconut yoghurt, cucumber, garlic, lemon and dill. Mash the avocado, mix everything and chill for 30 min.
2	Salmon with salsa verde	20 min · 480 kcal	Salmon 200 g, parsley, capers, anchovies, lemon and EVOO. Cook the salmon 4 min per side, blend the sauce and serve together.
3	Andalusian gazpacho	10 min · 140 kcal	Tomato 600 g, cucumber, pepper, soaked bread, sherry vinegar and EVOO. Blend very fine, strain and chill for 2 h.
4	Homemade hummus	10 min · 220 kcal	Chickpeas 400 g, tahini 3 tbsp, lemon, garlic, EVOO and cumin. Blend until creamy and dust with paprika.
5	Mediterranean omelette	15 min · 320 kcal	3 eggs, aubergine, pepper, cherry tomatoes and feta. Fry the vegetables, add the egg and set over a low heat.
6	Pasta with rocket pesto	15 min · 520 kcal	Wholegrain pasta 120 g, rocket 60 g, parmesan, pine nuts, garlic and EVOO. Raw pesto, tossed through the pasta al dente.
7	Provençal lentils	30 min · 420 kcal	Lentils 150 g, tomato, carrot, celery, thyme, bay and EVOO. Fry the vegetables, add the lentils and simmer for 25 min.
8	Baked sea bream with potatoes	35 min · 510 kcal	Sea bream 300 g, potato 200 g, tomato, olives, capers and white wine. Bake at 200 °C for 25 minutes.
9	Lebanese tabbouleh	15 min · 280 kcal	Bulgur 80 g, parsley, mint, tomato, cucumber, lemon and EVOO. Soak the bulgur, mix cold and leave to rest for 30 min.
10	Shakshuka	20 min · 380 kcal	Crushed tomato 400 g, pepper, onion, cumin, smoked paprika and 3 eggs. Fry the base, crack in the eggs and cover until they set.

ABOUT OLIVE OIL

Use extra virgin raw for dressing and virgin for cooking. Contrary to what is often said, extra-virgin olive oil stands up well to the temperature of a domestic frying pan, thanks to its antioxidants and its high oleic acid content.

20 PREMIUM RECIPES · PART 2

#	RECIPE	TIME · KCAL	INGREDIENTS AND METHOD
11	Salmorejo from Córdoba	10 min · 260 kcal	Tomato 1 kg, bread 150 g, garlic, EVOO 60 ml and salt. Blend very fine until it emulsifies and serve with hard-boiled egg and ham.
12	Light aubergine parmigiana	40 min · 390 kcal	Baked (not fried) aubergine, crushed tomato, basil, light mozzarella and parmesan. Layer it up and grill for 15 min.
13	Cod with chickpeas and spinach	25 min · 470 kcal	Desalted cod 200 g, chickpeas 200 g, spinach, garlic, paprika and EVOO. Sauté, add the cod and cook for 8 min.
14	Lemon and oregano chicken	25 min · 420 kcal	Chicken breast 200 g, lemon, oregano, garlic, EVOO and stock. Sear the chicken, deglaze with lemon and stock, reduce for 5 min.
15	Wholegrain mushroom risotto	35 min · 520 kcal	Brown rice 100 g, mixed mushrooms, onion, vegetable stock, white wine and parmesan. Add the stock a ladle at a time.
16	Sicilian caponata	30 min · 240 kcal Vegan	Aubergine, celery, onion, tomato, capers, olives, vinegar and a pinch of honey. Stew for 20 min and serve warm.
17	Fresh anchovies in vinegar	15 min + 24 h · 180 kcal	Cleaned fresh anchovies, wine vinegar, garlic, parsley and EVOO. Freeze for 48 h beforehand for safety, then marinate in vinegar.
18	Authentic Greek salad	10 min · 310 kcal	Tomato, cucumber, red onion, green pepper, kalamata olives, a block of feta and oregano. No lettuce, and be generous with the EVOO.
19	Pisto manchego with egg	35 min · 350 kcal	Courgette, aubergine, pepper, onion and tomato. Fry each one separately, bring them together and finish with a poached egg on top.
20	Greek yoghurt with figs and walnuts	3 min · 290 kcal	Greek yoghurt 200 g, fresh figs, walnuts 20 g, honey and cinnamon. The Mediterranean dessert par excellence.

HOW TO FIT ANY RECIPE TO YOUR MACROS

Protein and vegetables are fixed; carbohydrate and oil are your adjustment dials. To raise calories, add 10 g of oil (90 kcal) or 30 g of uncooked rice (105 kcal). To lower them, do the opposite. Never touch the protein.

WEEKLY SHOPPING LIST

	SECTION	PRODUCT	WEEKLY QUANTITY	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
☐	Fruit and vegetables	Tomatoes	1.5 kg	Ripe, for sauces and salmorejo
☐	Fruit and vegetables	Baby spinach	400 g	For salads and sautés
☐	Fruit and vegetables	Assorted peppers	4–6 units	Of every colour
☐	Fruit and vegetables	Aubergine and courgette	2 of each	Pisto, caponata and omelette
☐	Fruit and vegetables	Cucumber and cherry tomatoes	2 + 250 g	Fresh salads
☐	Fruit and vegetables	Seasonal fruit	2 kg	Mixed, for snacks
☐	Protein	Fresh salmon	600 g	Refrigerated, use within 2 days
☐	Protein	Tinned tuna in EVOO	6 tins	For salads and pasta
☐	Protein	Chicken breast	1 kg	Skinless, grilled or baked
☐	Protein	Free-range eggs	18 units	Code 0 or 1 stamped on the shell
☐	Protein	Chickpeas and lentils	500 g of each	Cooked in a jar, or dried
☐	Protein	White fish	500 g	Hake, cod or sea bream
☐	Dairy	Plain Greek yoghurt	8 units	No added sugars
☐	Dairy	Feta cheese	200 g	For salads and gratins
☐	Store cupboard	Extra-virgin olive oil	1 L a month	First cold pressing
☐	Store cupboard	Wholegrain pasta and rice	500 g of each	The base of your lunches
☐	Store cupboard	Oats, quinoa and couscous	500 g in total	Cereal rotation
☐	Nuts	Almonds and walnuts	200 g of each	Raw, unsalted and untoasted
☐	Herbs	Oregano, basil, thyme, rosemary	Assorted	Fresh beats dried

THE MEDITERRANEAN LABEL RULE

If a product has more than five ingredients on the label, or your grandmother would not recognise it as food, it is not part of this pattern. Buy local, seasonal and unprocessed.

WHERE EVERY NUMBER COMES FROM

Every number in this document comes from sources that are public, free and checkable. Not one figure is invented, rounded for convenience or copied from another popular publication. This page exists so that you can verify it yourself.

WHY THESE SOURCES AND NO OTHERS

Works of the United States federal government are not subject to copyright (17 U.S.C. § 105). That makes a handful of agencies the only source of nutrition and training data that is both first-rate and legally free. This is not restricted material: it is public material that almost nobody opens.

WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING FOR	WHAT YOU WILL FIND	WHERE
Reference intakes	RDA, AI and tolerable upper intake level for every vitamin and mineral	ods.od.nih.gov
Food composition	The full profile of any food, nutrient by nutrient	fdc.nal.usda.gov
Dietary guidelines	Dietary patterns and limits for added sugars, saturated fat and sodium	health.gov
Physical activity guidelines	The weekly dose, its response curve and the strength requirement	health.gov
Physical readiness doctrine	FM 7-22: training, nutrition, sleep and mental readiness	armypubs.army.mil
Lifting equation	How much weight is reasonable to lift in each specific situation	cdc.gov/niosh
Food safety	Safe internal temperatures and the danger zone	foodsafety.gov
Health claims	What may legally be claimed about a nutrient in Europe, and what was refused	European Commission register

HOW THIS DOCUMENT CHECKS ITSELF

The reference figures are not typed by hand: they live in a data module that the typesetting program verifies before writing a single line. It checks that the macronutrient ranges can add up to one hundred per cent of energy, that none of the 19 micronutrients has a recommended value above its own ceiling without a note explaining why, and that no safe cooking temperature falls inside the danger zone. If a single check fails, the document is not typeset.

REFERENCE VALUES ARE POPULATION VALUES

They describe what covers the needs of most healthy adults. They are not an individual prescription, they do not account for disease, pregnancy, breastfeeding or medication, and no publication replaces assessment by a registered health professional. If you take medication, some of the nutrients named here interact with it in clinically relevant ways: do not change an intake or start a supplement without telling whoever prescribes for you.

TWO HOURS THAT SETTLE YOUR WHOLE WEEK

MINUTE	TASK	RESULT
0-10	Heat the oven to 200 °C and put rice and quinoa on to boil	Carbohydrate base for 4 days
10-25	A tray of roast vegetables: pepper, courgette, aubergine, onion	A side dish ready for 5 meals
25-40	Second tray: spiced chicken breasts and sweet potato	Protein and carbohydrate for 3 lunches
40-60	A pot of lentil or chickpea stew	Two complete pulse-based meals
60-75	A base tomato sofrito and a pesto sauce	Works for pasta, pisto and shakshuka
75-90	Wash and dry the leaves, cut the crudité	Salads in 30 seconds all week
90-105	Boil 6 eggs and make hummus	Snacks and emergency protein
105-120	Divide into containers and label each with the day	Zero decisions during the week

SAFE STORAGE

- Cool the dishes before sealing the container and refrigerate them within 2 hours.
- Cooked grains and pulses: 3-4 days in the fridge. Cooked fish: 2 days.
- Freeze in single portions anything you will not eat within 3 days.
- Salads are assembled at the last moment: dressed leaves spoil within hours.

TWENTY-EIGHT DAYS, AND THEN A LIFETIME

These menus are calculated for 75 kg: **scale every portion to your own weight** and start again from week 1. The Mediterranean pattern does not expire, because it bans no food group — which is exactly why it can be repeated without end.

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